



Sticky Sensor

Japanese team of researchers have developed a sticky sheet with sensors to measure electrical activity <http://dgit.in/StickySen>



Floating solar power

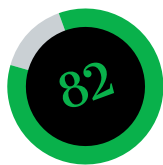
Japan's Kyocera Corporation is planning on building the world's largest floating solar power installation <http://dgit.in/KyoceraSol>

Xiaomi Piston 2 in-ear headphones

Budget audio done right

The Mi earphones have a 1.2 metre long Kevlar fibre cable that manages to stay untangled even when kept messily in a bag or in the pocket.

The cable appears quite hardy, at least up to the cylinder with the in-line controls, beyond which the split cable takes up a more traditional guise with its rubber coating. The rest of the earphones, including the 3.5mm connector and the earpiece unit that houses the drivers and the flanges, are made of ribbed metal. The overall build quality is fantastic, almost unbelievably so, especially when you consider the price of these earphones. Mi's pricing strategy is easily evidenced in this product category as well.



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Specifications

In-Line controls: Yes; **Cable length:** 1.2m; **Impedance:** 12-16 ohms; **Sensitivity:** 93 dB; **Rated Power:** 5 mW; **Frequency range:** 20 Hz to 20 KHz

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Asus Fonepad 7 Dual-SIM with ZenUI

A quintessential budget tablet

About six months ago, we reviewed the Asus Fonepad 7 Dual-SIM. Back then, we'd told you that the device was a good choice for those on the lookout for a budget tablet but it won't suit you if your requirements include resource intensive operations. Well, Asus has come out with a refresh of the Fonepad 7 but it's a very minor update. With it, the company has added the ZenUI, which had been introduced in its Zenfone series, to the tablet line-up as well.

It's the same 7-inch tablet, with thick bezels and an overall sturdy build. It's not much of a looker but fits the budget for



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Specifications

Display: 7 inch 1024x600p HD IPS; **Processor:** 1.2 GHz Intel Clover Trail Z2580 dual-core; **Operating System:** Android 4.3 Jelly Bean with ZenUI; **RAM:** 1GB; **ROM:** 8GB expandable to 32GB; **Battery:** 3950 mAh; **Camera:** 2MP rear, 0.3 MP (VGA) front

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those looking for an Android-based tablet at below ₹10,000. At ₹8,999, the price is right and with Asus there's not much to complain. We don't like the 2MP camera at the back and neither will you. But then again, if it is indeed irksome then you can check out the upgraded version of this tablet which costs a little over ₹10,000 and comes with a 5MP camera.

This one, however, is all about the ZenUI and we're happy to report that it doesn't change much in terms of the performance. The addition of a custom UI usually means lesser performance but the ZenUI doesn't affect it much. We did see some lag after filling the device up with apps not to the extent that'd make us label this a bad tablet. Also, the features added by the ZenUI make up for it.